

Panel 1/14 - 1. SOURCE, LAYER AND DATE CONTROL

1. SOURCE, LAYER AND DATE CONTROL
-> Early teachings survive through orally transmitted, school-specific and later redacted corpora.
-> Separate founder horizon, composition, recitation, redaction, manuscript and archaeology.
-> Traditional dates for Mahavira and Buddha differ; use sixth-fifth centuries BCE unless the tradition is named.
-> Text proves remembered doctrine or discipline; inscription and archaeology test institutions, donors and sites.

Follow: exact term -> named evidence -> historical mechanism -> qualification -> exam use.

Panel 2/14 - 2. SETTING AND THE SHRAMANA FIELD

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-> Agrarian expansion + towns + routes + states + social differentiation widened audiences and patronage.
-> Shramana included Jain, Buddhist, Ajivika, materialist and other renunciant positions.
-> Ritual cost, hierarchy and violence mattered, but no urban, merchant, iron or varna monocause is sufficient.
-> Brahmanical and shramana currents debated, competed, borrowed and later accommodated one another.

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Panel 3/14 - 3. JAIN ANTECEDENTS AND MAHAVIRA

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-> Jain tradition: 24 Tirthankaras; Rishabhanatha 1st, Parshvanatha 23rd, Mahavira 24th.
-> Parshva may preserve an earlier ascetic stratum; remote Tirthankara dates remain sacred tradition, not secure history.
-> Mahavira/Vardhamana/Nigantha Nataputta: renunciation -> austerity -> kevala knowledge -> teaching community.
-> Four-vow/ five-vow distinction is traditional; biography and chronology vary across sectarian memories.

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Panel 4/14 - 4. JAIN REALITY, KARMA AND RELEASE

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-> Jiva is conscious and enduring; ajiva includes matter, motion/rest media, space and time.
-> Activity and passion -> asrava (influx) -> bandha (bondage).
-> Samvara stops new influx; nirjara sheds accumulated karmic matter; moksha perfects the individual jiva.
-> Dharma-dravya and adharma-dravya are cosmological media, not simply moral good and evil.

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Panel 5/14 - 5. JAIN PATH, ETHICS AND MANY-SIDEDNESS

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-> Triratna: right faith, right knowledge, right conduct.
-> Five vows: ahimsa, satya, asteya, brahmacharya, aparigraha.
-> Mahavrata for ascetics; anuvrata and supplementary restraints for laity.
-> Anekantavada = many-sided reality; nayavada = standpoints; syadvada = conditioned predication; mature system is later.

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Panel 6/14 - 6. JAIN COMMUNITY, CANON, SECTS AND CONTINUITY

6. JAIN COMMUNITY, CANON, SECTS AND CONTINUITY
-> Fourfold community: monks, nuns, laymen and laywomen; household support sustains renunciation.
-> Pataliputra preservation and Valabhi redaction are later tradition-specific accounts.
-> Digambara-Svetambara division developed gradually: clothing, canon, images/practice and women's liberation differ.
-> Mathura, Udayagiri-Khandagiri, western India and Karnataka show regional patronage; Jainism changed while enduring.

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Panel 7/14 - 7. BUDDHA: BIOGRAPHY AND DATING

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-> Siddhartha Gautama, a Sakya, is remembered through four sights, renunciation and search among teachers.
-> Extreme austerity rejected -> awakening at Bodh Gaya -> first sermon at Sarnath -> teaching career.
-> Mahaparinibbana at Kushinagara; Lumbini pillar gives early epigraphic support to birthplace memory.
-> Long and short chronologies differ; sacred biography is not a contemporary diary.

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Panel 8/14 - 8. BUDDHIST DIAGNOSIS AND MIDDLE PATH

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-> Four Noble Truths: dukkha, origin, cessation and path.
-> Middle Way rejects sensual indulgence and self-mortification.
-> Eightfold Path: view, intention, speech, action, livelihood, effort, mindfulness and concentration.
-> Wisdom + ethical conduct + mental discipline form an integrated practice, not a mechanical staircase.

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Panel 9/14 - 9. CONDITIONALITY, NO-SELF AND NIRVANA

9. CONDITIONALITY, NO-SELF AND NIRVANA
-> Dependent origination: conditioned arising and cessation; not fate, first cause or a permanent substance.
-> Anicca = impermanence; anatta = no permanent independent self; dukkha = conditioned unsatisfactoriness.
-> Five aggregates analyse the person; intentional karma sustains rebirth without an eternal soul.
-> Nirvana ends greed, hatred, delusion and the rebirth process; it is not mere death or nihilism.

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Panel 10/14 - 10. SANGHA, VINAYA, LAITY AND WOMEN

10. SANGHA, VINAYA, LAITY AND WOMEN
-> Bhikkhu/bhikkhuni communities operate through Vinaya; upasaka/upasika provide food, robes, medicine and residence.
-> Lay-monastic reciprocity links merit, teaching, routes, towns and agrarian support.
-> Mahapajapati Gotami tradition and Therigatha attest women's agency; garudhamma transmission is layered and debated.
-> Access widened beyond hereditary ritual privilege, yet caste, obligation and patriarchy did not vanish.

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Panel 11/14 - 11. COUNCILS, CANONS AND EARLY SCHOOLS

11. COUNCILS, CANONS AND EARLY SCHOOLS
-> Rajagriha, Vaishali and Pataliputra councils are conventional, school-specific institutional memories.
-> No single pan-Buddhist fourth council: Kanishka-Kashmir and Sri Lankan writing-down traditions differ.
-> Theravada Pali Tipitaka = Vinaya, Sutta, Abhidhamma; other schools preserved Vinayas, Agamas and Abhidharma.
-> Sthavira and Mahasanghika lineages are complex; Theravada is not every Sthavira school and not 'Hinayana'.

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Panel 12/14 - 12. MAHAYANA, EMPTINESS AND VAJRAYANA

12. MAHAYANA, EMPTINESS AND VAJRAYANA
-> Mahayana emerged gradually around the early centuries BCE/CE through diverse texts and communities.
-> Bodhisattva ideal and paramitas widen the salvific horizon; Maitreya is the future Buddha, not exclusively Mahayana.
-> Madhyamaka uses emptiness/dependent designation; emptiness is not non-existence.
-> Vajrayana's mantra, mandala, deity yoga and tantric texts are later first-millennium developments.

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Panel 13/14 - 13. PATRONAGE, SPREAD, MONASTERIES AND ART

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-> Ashoka's inscriptions support Buddhist patronage and sangha concern; dhamma is broader than Buddhist doctrine.
-> Kanishka matters to north-western networks, but council and conversion details are later traditions.
-> Rulers + merchants + artisans + women + monks/nuns + local donors sustained routes, monasteries and education.
-> Stupa, chaitya and vihara; Sanchi, Bharhut, Amaravati, Karle, Ajanta, Nalanda and Gandhara require phase-specific dating.

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Panel 14/14 - 14. COMPARISON, DECLINE AND EXAM VERDICT

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-> Jainism: enduring jiva, material karma, rigorous ahimsa; Buddhism: anatta, intentional karma, Middle Path.
-> Both formed renunciant-lay communities and questioned exclusive ritual authority, but neither was uniformly egalitarian.
-> Buddhist contraction in India was regional and multicausal; Himalayan/eastern survival, Asian expansion and revival matter.
-> Answer route: context -> doctrine -> institution -> patronage/material evidence -> variation -> qualified verdict.

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